# Kellen Downey

MS Business Analytics, USC Marshall | Python, SQL & R | Summer 2027 internships

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| **USC AI Case Competition** Semifinalist | **General Atomics** Defense Intern | **WPSA 2025** Research Presenter | **3.7** Undergrad GPA |

## EDUCATION

**University of Southern California, Marshall School of Business** — M.S. Business Analytics — Expected Dec 2027

- Business Analytics Student Association (BASA) · USC Symphony Orchestra (cello)

**Chapman University** — B.A. Economics & B.A. Political Science (Political Economy) — May 2026

- Certificate of Applied Statistical Analysis (Anderson Center for Economic Research)
- Presidential Scholarship (highest merit award) · Order of Omega (top 3% academically) · Dean's List 2022, 2024
- Delta Tau Delta: organized the annual national fundraiser, the most successful philanthropic event in the fraternity's history; elected to chapter Honor Board

## PROJECTS

**Trojan Deadline Hub: AI Academic Planner** — USC AI Case Competition, Semifinalist — Fall 2026

- Co-designed an AI planner that turns full-semester syllabi into one calendar of every deadline, exam, and grade weight, replacing manual searches across Brightspace, PDFs, and assignment instructions.
- Built trust into the AI: students verify every extracted date before it is saved, and missing or TBD dates are flagged for confirmation instead of guessed.
- Scoped six core features (syllabus scanner, calendar, task tracking, weekly planner, course hub, workload estimator); the estimator recommends start dates and splits long assignments into study sessions.

**Podcast Opportunity Explorer** — Team of 5, USC Marshall (DSO 576); competing in class build — Fall 2026

- Building a decision-support app that screens the Podcast Index (4.7M feeds, 5 GB SQLite, 42 fields) for iHeartMedia acquisition and Riverside.fm localization decisions: six adjustable filters, a step-by-step attrition count, and a built-in definitions-and-limits panel.
- Designed the architecture (data loader, screening rules, Streamlit UI) and SQL-side filtering so the app handles millions of rows without loading them into memory; audited pytest coverage against what a podcast buyer needs.
- Python · SQL · SQLite · pandas · Streamlit · pytest · Git/GitHub

## EXPERIENCE

**Strategic Development Intern** — General Atomics, San Diego, CA — Jun – Aug 2025

- Analyzed budget allocations for a multi-million-dollar Unmanned Aircraft System program with the U.S. Department of Defense.
- Built Power BI dashboards, ran financial regressions, and authored proposal materials for government contracts.

**Graduate Assistant, Graduate & International Programs** — USC Gould School of Law — Fall 2026 – Present

- Screen graduate applications against admissions criteria for completeness and fit ahead of committee review.

**Legal Intern** — Children's Law Center of California, Monterey Park, CA — Aug – Dec 2024

- Reviewed and synthesized ~50 case files per day, briefing staff attorneys on key findings; supported client intake interviews.

**Earlier:** Sweetgreen Service Professional, 2024 (piloted Infinite Kitchen automation rollout across stores) · Chick-fil-A Shift Lead, 2019–2023 (ran shifts at a franchise averaging $30K daily revenue)

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

**Political Science Researcher** — Chapman University (Advisor: Dr. Lewis Luartz) — Jan 2024 – May 2025

- Specialized in multiple and linear regression modeling in R and Python to test the drivers of affective polarization; co-authored "Affective Polarization, Attempted Assassinations, and Support in the 2024 Presidential Election."
- Presented at the Western Political Science Association Annual Conference as the only Chapman undergraduate presenting at a professional conference in 2025; earned three travel grants.

**Capstone Researcher: Loneliness & Political Violence** — Chapman (Advisor: Dr. Ann Gordon) — Aug – Nov 2025

- Ran an independent regression-based study of how loneliness relates to support for political violence.

**Rental Property ROI Model** — Chapman, MGSC 310 (machine learning) — Fall 2025

- Engineered a Python model on thousands of San Diego County home sales and rentals (bedrooms, bathrooms, renovation status, school proximity) to forecast rental income and rank listings by projected ROI.

## SKILLS

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| **Programming & data** | Python (pandas, pytest), SQL (DBeaver), R, Stata, Streamlit, Git/GitHub |
| **Analytics** | Multiple & linear regression, predictive modeling, machine learning, econometrics, generative AI |
| **Tools** | Power BI, Excel (dashboards), Bloomberg Terminal |